

AFL MicroCore® Cable Handling Tips for the Installer

Although AFL Telecommunications MicroCore® fibre optic cable is quite robust, listed below are some guidelines for handling and installing MicroCore cable.

- Do not remove the protective wrapping from the reel until the cable is ready to be installed. This protective wrapping may be a plastic wrap, corflute or wooden lags attached to the reel. This is crucial to keep the cable as clean as possible as well as to prevent any possible damage to the cable while it is stored or shipped to the final installation location.
- Once the cable is ready to be installed and the protective covering is removed, inspect the reel for imperfections including nails and broken flanges, which may cause problems during the installation process. Release the inner end of the cable, which is connected to the outside of the reel.
- Measure the diameter of the cable to verify that it is within the required diameter specifications. For best results, measure the cable diameter with a set of digital calipers. Measure the diameter of the cable on the outside layer of the reel as well as the inner layer, which is found on the side of the reel.
- As the cable is pulled from the reel to the installation equipment, avoid contact with the ground to prevent soiling the cable jacket. Dirt and moisture may interfere with the installation equipment mechanisms. During installation, as the cable is fed into the installation equipment, it should be wiped with a clean rag to remove any dirt or moisture.
- If some slack is pulled from the reel to the installation equipment, monitor any loops that form as the slack is taken back up. Loops of slack that are pulled straight can easily kink the cable. Kinking fibre optic cable of any type will damage internal cable components, including the glass fibres within. The minimum bend radius for these cable are:

CABLE TYPE	PART NUMBER ¹	UNDER LOAD (mm)	NO LOAD (mm)
12F to 144F MicroCore (NY)	UTE6**FA+++BE	160	80
	UME6**FA0¥¥BE		
288F MicroCore (NY)	UTEC**FA288BE	250	125
12F to 144F MicroCore (NY+Thin PE)	UTN6**FD+++BE	180	90
	UMN6**FD0¥¥BE		
288F MicroCore (NY+Thin PE)	UTNC**FD288BE	270	135

¹ Refer to relevant AFL cable technical data sheet for corresponding Part Numbers.

- If a significant length of cable is to be removed from the reel before installation, it is crucial that the cable be laid in a figure-8 pattern to avoid twisting or tangling of the cable.
- Avoid stepping on the cable.